One of the famous quotes by a great entrepreneur and a visionary leader, Steve Jobs says... "Have the courage to follow your heart and intuition." In another words, "follow your heart and your instinct". Well, his career may seem successful in this present thing that is passing away. But unfortunately for others, **following their heart and instincts doesn't always lead to a good outcome,** in fact, it was disastrous. Some got deeply disappointed, broken-hearted, worst-case some lost their lives.

And so, there comes another interesting quote from an Austrian psychotherapist. He said: Follow your heart but take your brain with you.

Brothers, which is which? Have you ever found yourself in such a situation? Maybe you asked a mature brother or sister for advice, yes, you genuinely want to know what you should do? But then they gave you an answer you **didn't really want to hear**? No, no, no, no, I can't settle for that. We begin to have such thoughts. Many times, we've already made up our minds. We just hoped the person would confirm our decision.

Something very similar happened in Jeremiah's day. Discussing our theme for tonight treasures. **They Asked, but They Did Not Listen.**

What did they ask for? You'd want to look at their request at our first read scripture, **Jeremiah 42:1-3 "42Then all the army chiefs, and Jo·ha'nan the son of Ka·re'ah, Jez·a·ni'ah the son of Ho·shai'ah, and all the people, from the least to the greatest, approached 2and said to Jeremiah the prophet: "Hear, please, our request for favor, and pray in our behalf to Jehovah your God, in behalf of all this remnant, for just a few of many are left, as you can see. 3May Jehovah your God tell us the way we should walk and what we should do.""".** Brothers, this request wasn't light at all. If you look closely at verse 1 everybody was involved. So, this wasn't just a few influential people making a decision for everybody. Right from the big men in authorities the army chiefs, it said, Johanan, and from the least to the greatest. So, we could even say children joined in the request.

You can picture the scene, soldiers, men, women, teenagers, together with little children asking for help. Lives were at stake. At the time Jerusalem had been destroyed, and these were the remains of Judah, few of them verse 2 concluded it, as you can see. You can now see a whole kingdom in your eyesight, let say, now the whole population of Ghana cannot even reach up to half a plot of land, you can count them in 5 minutes; their population has drastically reduced to North Beachway English Congregation publishers in this hall. Just a few people.

According to the Insight reference, giving details about what had happened right after Jerusalem destruction and deportation to Babylon in 607 B.C.E. Johanan, who was one of the chief military man we mentioned earlier, had gone to inform the governor Gedaliah of a plot to assassinate him. Gedaliah had been appointed by the King of Babylon, over the remnants. Yet, Gedaliah did not believe them, and as a result he was assassinated.

And so, Johanan, being a chief army, he tried avenging this assassin, but the assassin escaped to Ammon. Now, fearing that the Babylonians would get to know what had happened and retaliate, Johanan and all the people, went up to Jeremiah, did that was penned down in this verse we just read, coming back to verse 2, they said **to Jeremiah the prophet**, "**Hear, please, our request for favor, and pray in**

our behalf to Jehovah your God, in behalf of all this remnant". Now in verse 3 their request. "**3May Jehovah your God tell us the way we should walk and what we should do."** What a fine way to seek request. And that's something we can imitate.

Friends, what is Jehovah's response? Please go down to verse 9 and 10. Same chapter Jeremiah 42:9,10. The prophet Jeremiah said to them. **9He said to them: "This is what Jehovah the God of Israel says, to whom you sent me to present your request for favor before him: 10'If you will indeed remain in this land, then I will build you up and not tear you down, and I will plant you and not uproot you, for I will feel regret over the calamity I have caused you.** This response is crystal clear. If you will indeed remain in this land, then I will build you up, I will not tear you down. I will plant you and not uproot you. For I will feel regret over the calamity I have caused you. In fact, in the next few verses at verse19 it was straightforward. **19"Jehovah has spoken against you, O remnant of Judah. Do not go to Egypt. "Do not go to Egypt" You should know for a certainty that I have warned you today.** The little children wouldn't even need any further explanation of this response by the prophet from Jehovah; it was very comprehensible. How much more will the army chiefs and the older people.

However, will they listen? Now comes the important question. They have asked Jehovah nicely, Jehovah have also answered simply. What will they do now? See that at our final read scripture, Jeremiah 43:4-7 "**4So Jo·ha'nan the son of Ka·re'ah and all the army chiefs and all the people disobeyed the voice of Jehovah to remain in the land of Judah. 5Instead, Jo·ha'nan the son of Ka·re'ah and all the army chiefs took with them all the remnant of Judah who had returned to reside in the land of Judah from all the nations where they had been dispersed. 6They took the men, the women, the children, the daughters of the king, and everyone whom Neb·u'zar·ad'an the chief of the guard had left with Ged·a·li'ah the son of A·hi'kam the son of Sha'phan, as well as Jeremiah the prophet and Bar'uch the son of Ne·ri'ah. 7And they went into the land of Egypt, for they did not obey the voice of Jehovah, and they went as far as Tah'pan·hes."**

How would you feel if you were to be Jehovah? Happy? Or Sad. These people asked but they did not obey the voice of Jehovah. They carried everyone including Jeremiah to Egypt.

What about we, we're alive today, we know we have the promise of everlasting life. We know what the future holds. There will be many directions and counsel. And so, the personal question in our workbook. Ask ourselves. **'When I receive Bible-based counsel, do I apply it—even if it's not what I want to hear?**'—w25.07 5 ¶14. We even can discuss at the close of meeting with our brothers sisters to incite to have meaningful interactions that would save both you and I.

We have this wonderful example from our picture illustration. Please, what do you see? This black woman is a matured sister; she shares a bible-based advice on dating with the younger sister from the YOUNG PEOPLE ASK. Dating—Part 1: Am I Ready to Date?

Are you dating just because you want to be in a relationship? Just to enjoy attention from the opposite sex? When you know it's inappropriate. Maybe the younger sister really likes someone, she is emotionally attached. Dating without the goal of marriage is like going to a job interview without the goal of finding employment. Now imagine you're that younger sister. Would you be happy to hear that advice? We would not want to displease Jehovah like Johanan and the rest of the people.

We have learnt tonight that Johanan and the people **asked** Jehovah for direction, but when they received an answer, they didn't like, they **rejected it**.
May we all Be **willing to follow the bible-based guidance we receive** from the elders, matured Christian, the faithful and discreet slave, especially when Bible-based counsel challenges what we want to do, they are all from Jehovah. It means our lives.